Rajat Khirid

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Summary

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional and DevOps/Cloud Engineer with 3+ years scaling production workloads on AWS and Azure. Delivered $200K/year in cloud cost savings, faster infrastructure delivery via Terraform and ArgoCD, and sub-5-minute incident resolution through SRE-driven observability. Day-to-day work spans CI/CD, Kubernetes (EKS, Karpenter, KEDA), serverless, and observability tooling.

Skills

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, ECS, EKS, Lambda, Aurora/RDS, Redshift, ElastiCache/Valkey, S3, EFS, SQS, Athena, API Gateway, Step Functions, IAM, Graviton, Spot, Savings Plans), Microsoft Azure, GCP
Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Helm, EC2 User Data
CI/CD & GitOps: ArgoCD, Argo Workflows, Jenkins, GitHub Actions (self-hosted runners), AWS CodePipeline, Git, GitHub
Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, ECS, Karpenter, KEDA, HPA, Helm
Networking & DNS: Route 53, ACM/TLS certificate automation, Application Load Balancers, VPC, CloudFront
Monitoring & Observability: Grafana, Prometheus, New Relic, AWS CloudWatch
Programming & Scripting: Python, Bash, JavaScript, SQL, Linux (Ubuntu, Amazon Linux)
Practices: Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), Incident Management, Root Cause Analysis (RCA), High Availability, Auto-Scaling, FinOps & Cost Optimization, Capacity Planning, Mentoring, Agile/Scrum
Spoken Languages: English, French (B1), Hindi, Marathi

Experience

Amber | *DevOps Engineer SDE1* Dec 2024 - Present

- Sole DevOps engineer for 8+ months, owning all production AWS infrastructure and internal tooling for 50+ services serving 50,000+ monthly active users across global environments, with end-to-end accountability for reliability, scalability, and cost.
- Manage EKS workloads with Helm and ArgoCD deployments, autoscaling, and resource tuning, improving cluster utilization by 24%.
- Owned a company-wide cost optimization initiative cutting monthly AWS spend by 45% ($35–38K to $19–21K, roughly $200K/year) via Graviton and Spot adoption, Aurora and Redshift re-architecture, Savings Plans, and load balancer consolidation, with no impact on availability.
- Built CI/CD pipelines in Argo Workflows, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions, raising deployment frequency from a few releases a week to several a day.
- Codified infrastructure with Terraform across 4 AWS accounts using reusable modules and remote state, replacing manual provisioning and eliminating configuration drift.
- Manage production DNS and TLS via Route 53 and ACM, converting CNAME to A/ALIAS records to cut resolution latency, and automated SSL renewal pipelines for client-facing sites to eliminate expiry-driven outages.
- Strengthened observability with Grafana, Prometheus, and CloudWatch dashboards, SLO-based alerting, and on-call runbooks, holding production to 3–4 incidents with each detected and resolved within 5 minutes, followed by blameless post-mortems and preventative automation.
- Mentored engineers on Kubernetes, cloud, and CI/CD practices, and embedded with product teams to fast-track delivery of major projects.

IAMOPS | *DevOps Engineer* Oct 2023 - Dec 2024

- Architected Azure-to-AWS migrations using CloudFront, ECS, and RDS aligned with AWS Well-Architected practices, delivering $54K/year in cost reduction across multiple client workloads.
- Owned weekly engagements across 4 client accounts, presenting migration roadmaps and solution designs that improved stakeholder alignment and lifted CSAT.
- Deployed parallelized multi-environment CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, AWS CodePipeline, and EC2 User Data, cutting environment setup time 75% (2.5 hours to 40 minutes).

- Automated event-driven workflows with Lambda, API Gateway, and Step Functions, reducing recurring AWS spend 25% and eliminating 10+ hours/week of manual toil.
- Led SRE duties across on-call rotations, end-to-end RCA, and runbook authoring; instrumented client services with CloudWatch, Grafana, and New Relic to shorten detection and resolution of production issues.
- Authored modular Terraform IaC with workspaces and remote state, plus architecture diagrams, cutting provisioning time by over 80%.

Projects

ECS to EKS Migration | *AWS EKS, ECS, Kubernetes, Terraform, Helm, Docker, CI/CD* 2026

- Migrated 50+ containerized and non-containerized services from AWS ECS and EC2 to EKS, standing up cluster provisioning, managed node groups, IRSA-based pod identity, and VPC CNI networking.
- Implemented Karpenter for just-in-time provisioning of On-Demand and Spot node pools with SQS-driven Spot interruption handling, and KEDA for event-driven autoscaling on SQS queue depth where CPU/memory-based HPA was insufficient.
- Executed a zero-downtime cutover using blue-green traffic shifting behind an ALB Ingress Controller, with no customer-facing downtime across the migration window.

AWS Cost Optimization Program | *AWS Services, AWS Graviton, Spot, Savings Plans, Cost Explorer* 2025

- Drove an AWS cost reduction program over 2.5 months, cutting monthly spend from $35–38K to $19–21K (45%, roughly $200K/year annualized) across compute, database, storage, networking, and messaging.
- Re-architected the data tier by migrating Aurora Serverless to provisioned r7g Graviton instances with optimized storage, re-platforming Redis to Valkey on Graviton, and removing non-essential Multi-AZ replicas; secured Reserved Instance coverage once capacity became predictable.
- Reduced analytics spend by moving Redshift from dc2.large to RA3 nodes to decouple 2 TB of storage from minimal compute demand, and rerouting high-volume Athena scans to a right-sized analytical database, trading marginal query latency for a fraction of the cost.
- Shifted ECS Fargate workloads to EC2-backed Graviton capacity with Spot instances for fault-tolerant jobs, rightsized over-provisioned services, deprecated unused resources and environments, replaced hosted CI runners with self-hosted GitHub Actions runners, and layered Compute Savings Plans after capacity modeling.
- Consolidated 14 Application Load Balancers down to 4 using host- and path-based routing rules, cut SQS costs by nearly 90% by tuning long-polling receive wait times, and automated EFS lifecycle jobs to purge stale data.

Agentic CI/CD Failure Triage & Auto-Remediation | *LLM Agents, MCP, Jenkins, Argo Workflows* 2026

- Shipped a Kubernetes-native AI agent watching Jenkins and Argo Workflows across 30+ pipelines and 40 services, using an LLM layer to parse job logs and classify failures by root cause (dependency, config, infrastructure, transient).
- Delivered Slack alerts carrying root-cause summaries and recommended fixes, cutting mean triage time by 70% and saving 8+ hours/week of manual log investigation.
- Automated closed-loop remediation that opens targeted GitHub pull requests for code and config defects and retries transient failures via the Jenkins MCP server, resolving 40% of failures without human intervention.
- Exposed a ChatOps interface over Jenkins MCP for natural-language build queries and job triggers, and packaged the agent as an RBAC-scoped Helm chart for least-privilege multi-environment deployment, cutting on-call escalations.

Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (SAP-C02) – Amazon Web Services
- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner – Amazon Web Services
- Microsoft Azure (AZ-900) – Microsoft

Education

Savitribai Phule Pune University 9.33/10.0 CGPA
Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science, Honors in Artificial Intelligence *Jul 2020 – Jun 2023*

Sinhgad Polytechnic 90.46%
Diploma in Computer Technology *Jul 2017 – Mar 2020*